

Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Evallo, Daniella Kim N.
Section / Class	BSIT-3G
Challenge Name	My Git
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	08/09/2026
Flag Format Given	PicoCTF{...}

1. Challenge Description

The challenge provided a Git repository hosted on a custom server. The goal was to clone the repository, follow the instructions in README.md, and push the required flag file using the correct Git identity so that the server would reveal the flag.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

I first read the challenge page and noted the clone command, the password, and the hint about specifying the Git username and email. After cloning the repository, I checked its contents and opened README.md. The README explained that only flag.txt pushed by root:root@picoctf would be updated with the flag, so the Git identity was an important part of the solution.

3. Tools and Commands Used

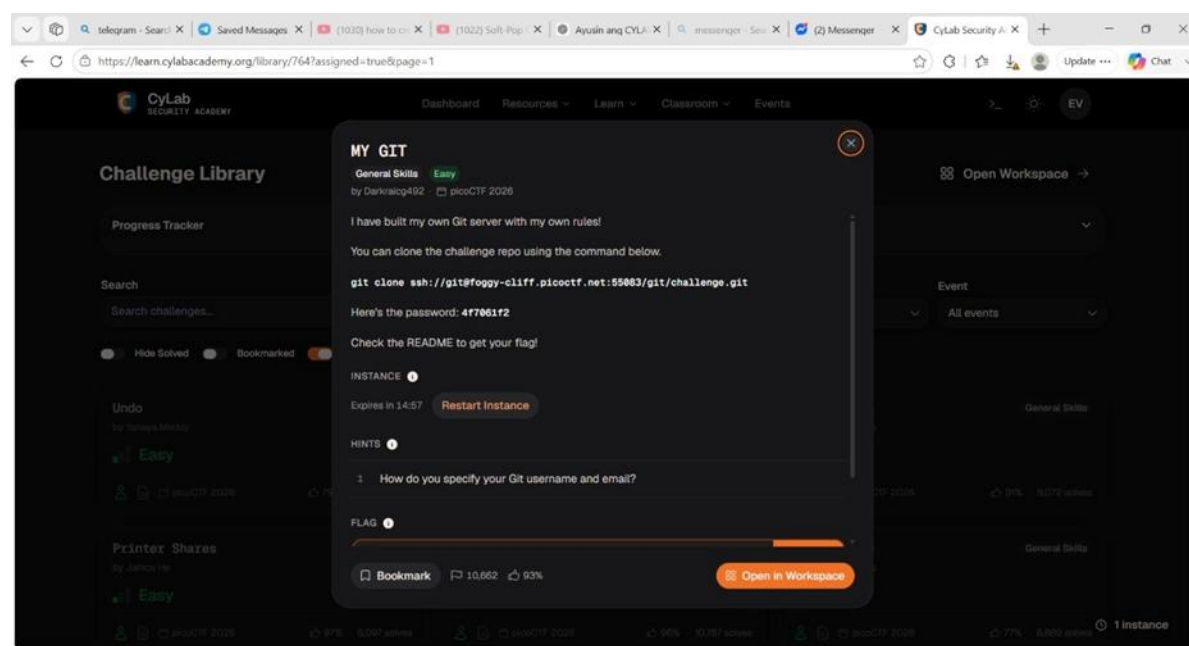
Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
git clone	Clone the challenge repository using the Git server address provided.	Repository cloned successfully.
ls -la	Check the files inside the cloned repository.	The .git directory and README.md were present.
cat README.md	Read the repository instructions before making changes.	README explained that flag.txt must be pushed by the specified root user.
git config user.email / user.name	Set the Git identity required by the repository rules.	Git identity was set to root@picoctf / root.

Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
git add / git commit	Stage flag.txt and create the required commit.	flag.txt was committed with message "Add flag".
git push origin master	Push the commit to the remote repository.	The remote accepted the push and returned the flag.

4. Solution Walkthrough

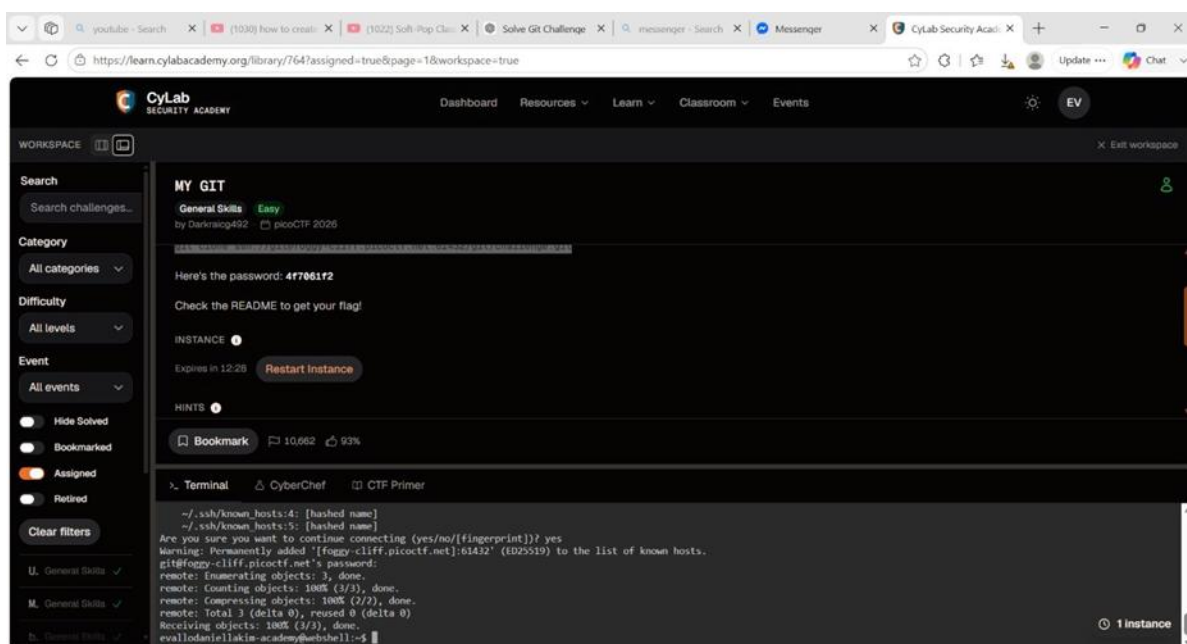
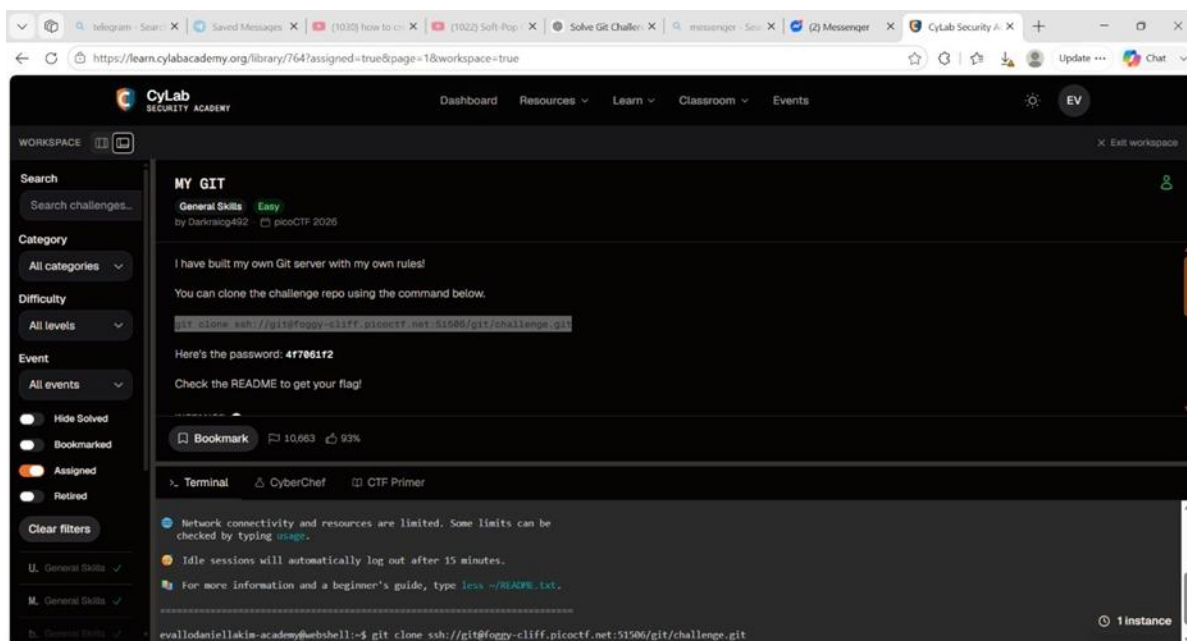
Step 1

I followed the repository instructions from the challenge page and README.md. The main idea was to make a normal Git push, but with the username and email configured exactly as required by the challenge. I first checked the MY GIT challenge page to see what was required. The page gave the Git clone command, a password, and a hint about setting the Git username and email. I used these details as my starting point.



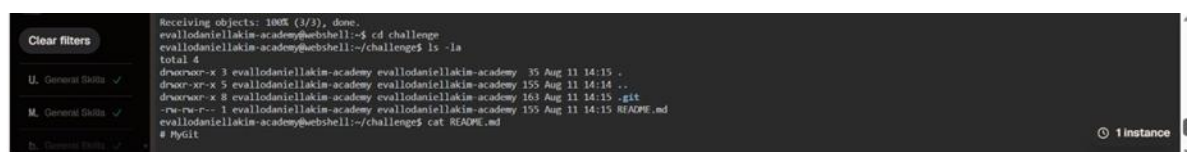
Step 2

Next, used the Git clone command from the challenge in the terminal. The repository started downloading, and I waited until the terminal showed that the files were received successfully.

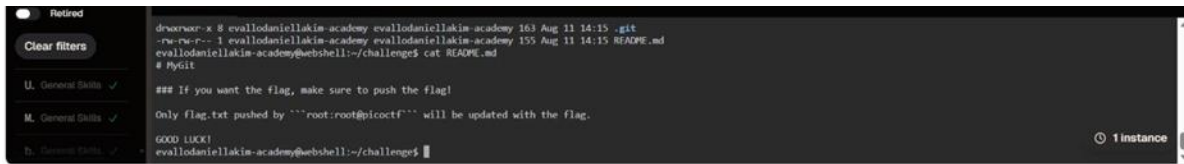


Step 3

After the repository was cloned, enter the challenge folder and used **ls -la** to check the files. I saw the **.git** folder and **README.md**. Then used **cat README.md** to read the instructions before making any changes.



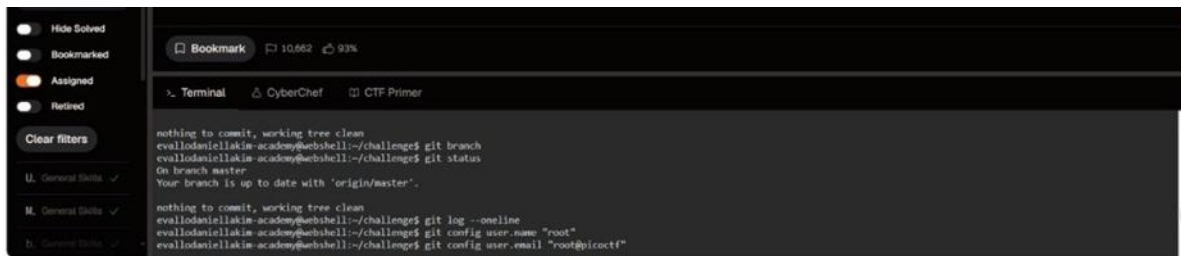
Then **README.md** showing that **flag.txt** must be pushed using the required **root:root@picocftf** identity.



```
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ cat README.md
## If you want the flag, make sure to push the flag!
Only flag.txt pushed by "root:root@picocftf" will be updated with the flag.
GOOD LUCK!
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge$
```

Step 4

The **README** showed that the flag would only be updated if **flag.txt** was pushed using the required Git identity. I set the Git username to **root** and the email to **root@picocftf** using the git config commands.

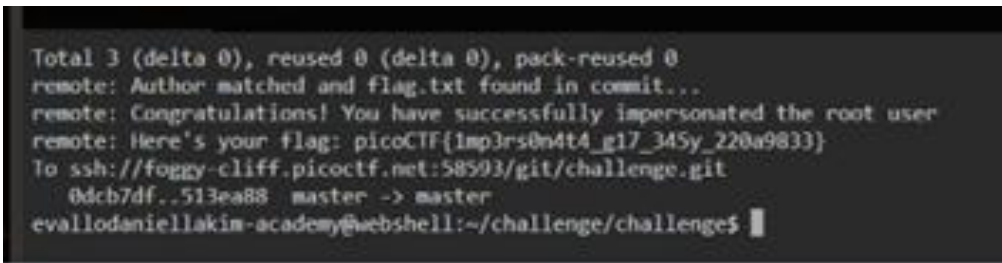


```
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git branch
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git status
On branch master
Your branch is up to date with 'origin/master'.

nothing to commit, working tree clean
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git log --online
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git config user.name "root"
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git config user.email "root@picocftf"
```

Step 5

Once the Git identity was set, Add the flag file and created the commit. Then pushed the master branch to the remote repository. The terminal showed that the remote accepted the commit and returned the flag, which meant the required Git identity was accepted.



```
Total 3 (delta 0), reused 0 (delta 0), pack-reused 0
remote: Author matched and flag.txt found in commit...
remote: Congratulations! You have successfully impersonated the root user
remote: Here's your flag: picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_220a9833}
To ssh://foggy-cliff.picocftf.net:58593/git/challenge.git
0dc67df..513ea88 master -> master
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge/challenge$
```

Step 6

Finally, copy the flag returned by the Git server and entered it in the flag field on the challenge page. After submitting it, the challenge accepted the answer.



```
1. How do you specify your Git username and email?

FLAG
picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_220a9833} Submit

Bookmark 10,574 93%

Terminal CyberChef CTF Primer

Total 3 (delta 0), reused 0 (delta 0), pack-reused 0
remote: Author matched and flag.txt found in commit...
remote: Congratulations! You have successfully impersonated the root user
remote: Here's your flag: picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_220a9833}
To ssh://foggy-cliff.picocftf.net:58593/git/challenge.git
0dc67df..513ea88 master -> master
evalldaniellakin-academy@webshell:~/challenge/challenge$
```

5. Flag

```
picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_220a9833}
```

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

This challenge focused on Git configuration and how commit author information can affect server-side repository rules. I learned that changing the Git username and email can be necessary when a challenge checks the identity attached to a commit. I also practiced the basic clone, add, commit, and push workflow.

7. References

[picoCTF 2026 | Denton's Blog](#)
